

SAILING TOWARD SOVEREIGNTY

India's Maritime Renaissance and the Dawn of a Global Shipbuilding Powerhouse

The Indian maritime sector is currently undergoing a monumental transformation, shedding colonial-era limitations to reclaim its historical status as a global seafaring leader. Under the visionary guidance of Hon'ble PM Shri Narendra Modi and the proactive leadership of Union Minister Shri Sarbananda Sonowal, the nation is executing a multi-trillion rupee strategy to dominate global trade routes and shipyards.



India's maritime legacy is thousands of years old, rooted in the ancient docks of Lothal and the sophisticated shipbuilding traditions of Odisha, Gujarat, and the Malabar coast. For centuries, Indian-built vessels commanded the crossroads of global trade, sailing to Rome, Southeast Asia, and East Africa while shaping cultural and commercial exchanges across the Indian Ocean. However, this indigenous ecosystem was systematically dismantled during the colonial era, which repurposed Indian ports into nodes for resource extraction and allowed the skills of master shipbuilders and seafarers to wither. By the modern era, India's share of global shipbuilding output had languished at less than one percent, despite its vast coastline of over 11,000 kilometers. The strategic imperative to reverse this decline arrived in 2014, when the government recognized that maritime capacity is not merely an economic asset but a pillar of national security and strategic autonomy.

Ports as Powerhouses: The Multi-Billion Tonne PPP Success Story

The first phase of this renaissance focused on port-led prosperity through a successful Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model. Over the last decade, cargo traffic at major ports grew by 47% to reach 855 million tonnes, while port capacity doubled to 1,681



Sh. Sarbananda Sonowal

Hon'ble Union Minister - Ports, Shipping & Waterways

> Let us build the ships that will carry the Viksit Bharat flag to every corner of the world. Let us reclaim our maritime glory, together". This resolve captures the essence of a nation no longer content with being a passive observer of the high seas, but one that is actively engineering its destiny as a premier global maritime powerhouse for the 21st century.